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THE UPDATE - courtesy of Mish Int'l (650) 324-9110 COMEY ATTACKS TRUMP:

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Former FBI Director James Comey blasts President Donald Trump as unethical and "untethered to truth" in a sharply critical new book. He describes Trump as fixated in the early days of his administration on having the FBI debunk salacious rumors he insisted were untrue but could distress his wife. In the forthcoming book, Comey compares Trump to a mafidon and calls his leadership of the country "ego driven and about personal loyalty."

CASTING COUCH: The union representing TV and movie actors, SAG-AFTRA, is calling for an end to auditions in private hotel rooms and residences in the wake of the Harvey Weinstein scandal.

CHARTER SCHOOLS: Wealthy charter school supporters are pouring millions of dollars behind former Los Angeles Mayor Antonio Villaraigosa, who is running in third place in the governor's race. The Sacramento Bee reports that Netflix CEO Reed Hastings has given $7 million to the committee run by the California Charter Schools Association, which backs Villaraigosa. Los Angeles philanthropist and developer Eli Broad contributed $1.5 million to the effort.

PARDON FOR SCOOTER POSSIBLE: President Trump is expected to pardon Lewis "Scooter" Libby, the former chief of staff to Vice President Dick Cheney, who was convicted by a special counsel of obstruction of justice and perjury in an investigation about the disclosure of a CIA employee's name, ABC News reports, citing anonymous sources. Libby was sentenced to 30 months in prison and fined $250,000, but his sentence was commuted by President George W. Bush, which kept him out of prison.

TPP U-TURN: President Trump ordered top administration officials yesterday to look at rejoining the Trans-PacifiPartnership, the sprawling trade pact he rejected three days after taking office. Rejoining the TPP would give Trump more leverage in his escalating trade feud with China, which is threatening higher tariffs on U.S. goods.

SOLAR PROGRAM SPURS SUITS: Homeowners are suing Los Angeles County and its partners, alleging a program that funds solar panels and other energy-efficient home improvements saddled them with loans they cannot afford. Two lawsuits target the county along with lenders Renovate America and Renew Financial.

RUNOFFS FOR ASSEMBLY SEATS: A Democrat and a Republican have advanced to a June runoff in each of two special elections to replace Los Angeles-area lawmakers who resigned amid sexual harassment allegations. Final vote tallies released yesterday show Democrat Jesse Gabriel facing Republican Justin Clark in the 45th Assembly District in the southwest San Fernando Valley. Democrat Luz Rivas and Republican Ricardo Benitez will compete in the 39th Assembly District in the northeast San Fernando Valley. The upcoming contests will determine who will replace Assemblymen Matt Dababneh and Raul Bocanegra, who both resigned last year.

FAMILY'S SUV PLUNGED: Recovered vehicle debris and belongings confirm that an SUV seen plunging into a storm-swollen Mendocino County river belonged to a family that disappeared last week while on a vacation, authorities said yesterday. The Thottapilly family from Santa Clarita in Los Angeles County was last heard from while driving along the redwood coast on April 8 amid a storm.

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